Worksheet A: Source Criticism and SIFT

Name: _____ Date: _____

Task 1: SIFT grid for three sources

in class, small groups, 30 min.; finish as homework

The instructor provides three sources: (1) a peer-reviewed study, (2) a newspaper article, (3) a Wikipedia entry. First enter the exact details, then your findings for each step. In step T, trace at least one number back to the original study. On the type of source: *primary* = own data (study), *secondary* = summarises studies (review, meta-analysis), *tertiary* = reports on them (press, encyclopedia), *grey* = published without a publisher or peer review (preprint, report, thesis).

	(1) Study	**(2) Newspaper article**	**(3) Wikipedia**
Details (author, title, date, link)			
Stop: What do I want to know? First impression?			
Investigate: Who is the source? What do others say?			
Find: Better or independent coverage?			
Trace: Where does the central number/claim come from?			
Type of source (primary, secondary, tertiary, grey)			
Weight (high/medium/low) and reason			